

Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-09-16

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Chronicles 9:35–10:14

9:35 Jeiel the father of Gibeon, whose wife's name was Maacah, dwelt at Gibeon.

9:36 His firstborn son was Abdon, then Zur, Kish, Baal, Ner, Nadab,

9:37 Gedor, Ahio, Zechariah, and Mikloth.

9:38 And Mikloth begot Shimeam. They also dwelt alongside their relatives in Jerusalem, with their brethren.

9:39 Ner begot Kish, Kish begot Saul, and Saul begot Jonathan, Malchishua, Abinadab, and Esh-Baal.

9:40 The son of Jonathan was Merib-Baal, and Merib-Baal begot Micah.

9:41 The sons of Micah were Pithon, Melech, Tahrea, and Ahaz.

9:42 And Ahaz begot Jarah; Jarah begot Alemeth, Azmaveth, and Zimri; and Zimri begot Moza;

9:43 Moza begot Binea, Rephaiah his son, Eleasah his son, and Azel his son.

9:44 And Azel had six sons whose names were these: Azrikam, Bocheru, Ishmael, Sheariah, Obadiah, and Hanan; these were the sons of Azel.

10:1 Now the Philistines fought against Israel; and the men of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell slain on Mount Gilboa.

10:2 Then the Philistines followed hard after Saul and his sons. And the Philistines killed Jonathan, Abinadab, and Malchishua, Saul's sons.

10:3 The battle became fierce against Saul. The archers hit him, and he was wounded by the archers.

10:4 Then Saul said to his armorbearer, "Draw your sword, and thrust me through with it, lest these uncircumcised men come and abuse me." But his armorbearer would not, for he was greatly afraid. Therefore Saul took a sword and fell on it.

10:5 And when his armorbearer saw that Saul was dead, he also fell on his sword and died.

10:6 So Saul and his three sons died, and all his house died together.

10:7 And when all the men of Israel who were in the valley saw that they had fled and that Saul and his sons were dead, they forsook their cities and fled; then the Philistines came and dwelt in them.

10:8 So it happened the next day, when the Philistines came to strip the slain, that they found Saul and his sons fallen on Mount Gilboa.

10:9 And they stripped him and took his head and his armor, and sent word throughout the land of the Philistines to proclaim the news in the temple of their idols and among the people.

10:10 Then they put his armor in the temple of their gods, and fastened his head in the temple of Dagon.

10:11 And when all Jabesh Gilead heard all that the Philistines had done to Saul,

10:12 all the valiant men arose and took the body of Saul and the bodies of his sons; and they brought them to Jabesh, and buried their bones under the tamarisk tree at Jabesh, and fasted seven days.

10:13 So Saul died for his unfaithfulness which he had committed against the LORD, because he did not keep the word of the LORD, and also because he consulted a medium for guidance.

10:14 But he did not inquire of the LORD; therefore He killed him, and turned the kingdom over to David the son of Jesse.

II. Key Summary

- 9:35–44 lists the family line of Saul, from Jeiel, Kish, and Saul down to Jonathan's descendant Azel and his six sons.
- The Philistines defeated Israel on Mount Gilboa. Saul's three sons were killed, and the badly wounded Saul fell on his own sword; the Israelites abandoned their cities, the Philistines fastened Saul's head in the temple of Dagon, and the valiant men of Jabesh Gilead brought back the bodies, buried them, and fasted seven days.
- The passage gives the reason for Saul's death: he was unfaithful to the LORD, did not

keep the word of the LORD, and consulted a medium instead of inquiring of the LORD, so the LORD killed him and turned the kingdom over to David the son of Jesse.

III. Passage Analysis

He Asked, But It Didn't Count

"While Saul was inquiring of God, he was also 'not keeping the word of the LORD.' That shows he only wanted to know his future, not to do God's will — so in God's eyes, it was the same as 'not inquiring of the LORD.'" [1]

Saul did say something to God, but he only wanted to know what was coming next, not what God wanted him to do. To God, really asking means being ready to listen and obey.

The King Fell, but God's Plan Didn't Stop

"God always has His valiant men. When one servant passes the scene, another arises to take his place. If Saul is gone, God raises up a David... God's work is bigger than any man, or any group of people." [2]

Israel's king was dead and the army had scattered, so it looked like everything was over. But the last line says God "turned the kingdom over to David" — where people failed, God kept going.

IV. Reflection Question

Last time you hit a problem, who did you ask first?

Saul ran to a medium instead of truly inquiring of the LORD; God is looking for people who ask Him and then follow His word.

References

[1] 華人基督徒查經資料網站 (Chinese Christian Bible Study Data Website),
歷代志上第十章拾穗 (1 Chronicles Comprehensive Interpretation),

<https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/13%20Chro/13GT10.htm>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, "1 Chronicles 10 – The Death of Saul",

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-chronicles-10/>